

Ghave, Guru of Spores — Spore Bank

Bracket 3 · 3/3 Game Changers · the commander is the token engine · 100 cards

Nonland 64	Avg MV 2.80	Token makers 15 + Ghave	Doublers 6	Drainers 10
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COMMANDER (1)

1 Ghave, Guru of Spores 5

LANDS (35)

1 Bayou
1 Blooming Marsh
1 Branchloft Pathway
1 Brightclimb Pathway
1 Command Tower
1 Concealed Courtyard
1 Darkbore Pathway
4 Forest
1 Gaea's Cradle
1 Gavony Township
1 Godless Shrine
1 Indatha Triome
1 Isolated Chapel
1 Marsh Flats
1 Overgrown Tomb
1 Phyrexian Tower
3 Plains
1 Sandsteppe Citadel
1 Savannah
1 Scrubland
1 Sunpetal Grove
3 Swamp
1 Temple Garden
1 Urborg, Tomb of Yawgmoth
1 Verdant Catacombs
1 Windswept Heath
1 Woodland Cemetery
1 Yavimaya, Cradle of Growth

RAMP & MANA (11)

1 Birds of Paradise
1 Cryptolith Rite
1 Cultivate
1 Farseek
1 Ictilli Explorer
1 Llanowar Elves
1 Nature's Lore
1 Oracle of Mul Daya
1 Sakura-Tribe Elder
1 Sol Ring
1 Three Visits

CARD DRAW (9)

1 Black Market Connections
1 Deadly Dispute
1 Idol of Oblivion
1 Mentor of the Meek
1 Moldervine Reclamation
1 Skullclamp
1 Sylvan Library
1 Tireless Tracker
1 Village Rites

REMOVAL & INTERACTION (8)

1 Anguished Unmaking
1 Assassin's Trophy
1 Aura Shards
1 Beast Within
1 Heroic Intervention
1 Path to Exile
1 Swords to Plowshares
1 Teferi's Protection

BOARD WIPES (1)

1 The Meathook Massacre

TOKEN ENGINES (13)

1 Adeline, Resplendent Cathar
1 Avenger of Zendikar
1 Bitterblossom
1 Brightcap Badger
1 Linging Souls
1 March of the Multitudes
1 Pest Infestation
1 Rosie Cotton of South Lane
1 Scute Swarm
1 Second Harvest
1 Slimefoot, the Stowaway
1 Springheart Nantuko
1 Tendershoot Dryad

COUNTER ENGINES (2)

1 Hardened Scales
1 Kami of Whispered Hopes

TOKEN DOUBLERS (6)

1 Anointed Procession
1 Chatterfang, Squirrel General
1 Doubling Season
1 Elspeth, Storm Slayer
1 Mondrak, Glory Dominus
1 Parallel Lives

SACRIFICE OUTLETS (4)

1 Ashnod's Altar
1 Phyrexian Altar
1 Priest of Forgotten Gods
1 Viscera Seer

DRAIN PAYOFFS (10)

1 Bastion of Remembrance
1 Blood Artist
1 Cruel Celebrant
1 Dictate of Erebos
1 Elas il-Kor, Sadistic Pilgrim
1 Grave Pact
1 Marionette Apprentice
1 Mirkwood Bats
1 Pitiless Plunderer
1 Zulaport Cutthroat

GHAVE, GURU OF SPORES — PILOT'S GAMEPLAN

0. The one-paragraph version

Ghaves is a bank. **Counters go in, Saprolings come out.** He arrives with five +1/+1 counters, and each one becomes a 1/1 Saproling for 1, at instant speed. Every creature you sacrifice to him (1) puts a counter back. You don't need to draw token makers to have a board: the commander is one. The 99 multiplies that (white and green doublers), turns every death into damage (Blood Artist, Zulaport, Grave Pact), and keeps Ghaves fed with more counters.

1. The curve you actually have

	MV1	MV2	MV3	MV4	MV5	MV6+	avg
Nonland incl. Ghaves (65)	10	19	19	10	6	1	2.80

35 lands, four land-fetchers (Nature's Lore, Farseek, Three Visits, Cultivate), Sakura-Tribe Elder, two dorks (Birds, Llanowar Elves), Sol Ring, and two extra land drops (Oracle of Mul Daya, Ictyll Explorer). X spells (March of the Multitudes, Pest Infestation) count as MV 1–3 here but scale with whatever mana you have. **Ghaves on turn 4 is the normal case.**

2. How Ghaves's two abilities work together

- **1, remove a +1/+1 counter from any creature you control → Saproling.** Not just Ghaves. A

Tireless Tracker's counters (one per Clue you crack), Avenger's Plants (a counter on each Plant per land) and a board pumped by Gavony Township are all in the bank too.

- 1, sacrifice a creature → +1/+1 counter on target creature. It's an instant-speed outlet that also refills the bank. Target Ghaves to keep him alive, or a Saproling to feed Skullclamp later.
- **Never remove his last counter by accident.** He is a 0/0 and dies immediately (CR 704.5f).
- Hardened Scales / Kami of Whispered Hopes make each sacrifice worth 2 counters (3 with both).

Doubling Season makes it 2, and doubles the Saprolings as well.

3. What makes tokens without anything dying first

Cheap: Bitterblossom, Springheart Nantuko, Brightcap Badger (its Fungus Frolic half), Adeline, Lingering Souls, Scute Swarm, Slimefoot, Rosie Cotton, Black Market Connections, Pest Infestation. **Burst / bigger:** March of the Multitudes (X, instant, convoke), Second Harvest, Tendershoot Dryad, Avenger of Zendikar, Elspeth, Storm Slayer. That's 15 cards plus the commander. By turn 3 on the draw you see one of the cheap ones 67% of the time, and **Ghaves covers the rest.**

Landfall (added 2026-09-25). Every land you play is a trigger. Tireless Tracker makes a Clue (card draw), Springheart Nantuko makes a 1/1, Scute Swarm copies itself once you have six lands, and Avenger's Plants each get a counter. Doublers double the Clues and Insects, and Chatterfang adds a Squirrel to each. Oracle of Mul Daya gives you a second land drop and lets you play lands off the top of your library. Ictyll Explorer gives another drop and lets you play lands from your graveyard. Fetchlands (Marsh Flats, Verdant Catacombs, Windswept Heath) are two triggers each, and with Ictyll you can replay the same fetch every turn. Ictyll mills a card per landfall, which can bin more fetches to replay.

Springheart Nantuko as a copier: bestow it (1) on a nonlegendary token engine (Tendershoot Dryad, Brightcap Badger, Scute Swarm, Tireless Tracker). Then every land lets you pay 1 for a token copy of that engine. Don't bestow it on Rosie, Slimefoot, Adeline or Chatterfang, because a copy of a legend dies to the legend rule.

4. Opening

- T1–T2:** a dork (Birds, Llanowar Elves), a land-fetcher, or Hardened Scales. Then Bitterblossom, Springheart Nantuko, Viscera Seer or Skullclamp.
- T3:** Adeline, Tireless Tracker, Lingering Souls, Rosie Cotton, Slimefoot, Scute Swarm, Kami of Whispered Hopes, or an Altar. Cast landfall creatures before your land drop.
- T4: Ghaves.** Leave 1–2 open after casting him if you can. Those are two instant-speed Saprolings, or an answer to removal (sacrifice in response).
- T5–T6:** a doubler (Anointed Procession, Parallel Lives, Mondrak, Doubling Season, Elspeth), then Grave Pact / Dictate / drainers.
- Mulligans:** keep 2–3 lands and a ramp piece. You don't need Ghaves in the opener, since he's in the command zone.

5. The engines to look for

- **Ghaves + a free outlet + Blood Artist / Zulaport.** Each 1 is a body; each sacrifice is a drain and the counter back.
- **Slimefoot:** "Whenever a Saproling you control dies, Slimefoot deals 1 damage to each opponent and you gain 1 life." Every Ghaves Saproling is a Zulaport on its own. Slimefoot's own 4 makes Saprolings too.
- **Skullclamp on a Saproling is two cards for 1.** Ghaves refills the Saproling for 1.

- **Moldervine Reclamation:** a card and a life for every creature death. Your draw engine once the board is going.
- **Mentor of the Meek:** pay 1 per Saproling to draw. It's your mana sink when there's nothing better.
- **Grave Pact / Dictate of Erebos:** every Saproling you sacrifice makes each opponent sacrifice a creature. Two Saprolings clear two blockers from every opponent.

6. Sequencing within your turn

1. **Upkeep:** Bitterblossom, Tendershoot (every upkeep, **including opponents'**). With Oracle out, check the top of your library before you draw.
1. **Main 1:** landfall payoffs first, then your land drop(s). Doublers and engines go down *before* you spend counters, so every Saproling is doubled.
1. **Attack:** Adeline makes one Human per opponent, already attacking. Gavony Township makes the whole board bigger. Attacking tokens that get blocked still drain on the way out.
1. **End step / opponents' turns:** Ghave works at instant speed. Hold mana and make Saprolings at the end of the turn before yours, or in response to a wipe (sacrifice everything for drain and Grave Pact edicts before it resolves).

7. The kill

- **Grind:** every turn, Saprolings in, sacrifices out, drain and Grave Pact edicts. Adeline and Gavony Township keep the combat route live. Wide boards with counters are hard to block.
- **Burst:** March of the Multitudes at the end of the turn before yours. Convoke with your tokens and untap into a doubled board. Or Avenger after a big land turn, Second Harvest before you sacrifice everything, or Meathook with drainers out.
- **Combo (declared):** see §8.

8. The declared combos (chosen-N; announce each iteration)

Every line is **Ghave + two cards**. Opponents can respond between iterations.

Pieces	Per iteration
Ashnod's Altar + any token doubler	Remove a counter (1) → 2 Saprolings. Altar one (2). Sacrifice the other to Ghave (1) → counter back. 0 mana, 2 deaths.
Phyrexian Altar + Doubling Season	Two removals → 4 Saprolings. 3 into the Altar, 1 into Ghave → 2 counters back. 0 mana, 4 deaths.
Phyrexian Altar + two token doublers	4 Saprolings per removal. 3 into the Altar, 1 into Ghave. +1, 4 deaths.
Pitiless Plunderer + any token doubler	2 Saprolings. Sacrifice one to Ghave → 2 Treasures pay both activations. +1 Saproling, 1 death.
Rosie Cotton + Ashnod's Altar (or Phyrexian)	Remove Ghave's counter (1) → Saproling → Rosie puts a counter back on Ghave. Altar the Saproling. +1 with Ashnod's (infinite mana), 0 with Phyrexian.

Chatterfang counts as a token doubler in every line above (a Squirrel for every Saproling). It stacks with the other doublers in either order — doublers commute (LEDGER 2026-09-24).

The one line that skips Ghave — Chatterfang + Pitiless Plunderer (added 2026-09-24, pilot opted in to combos): sacrifice a Squirrel to Chatterfang's ♠ → Plunderer makes a Treasure → Chatterfang adds a Squirrel → the Treasure pays the next ♠. One death and -1 toughness on a target per iteration, nothing spent. With no opposing creature, target the Squirrel you are sacrificing (CR 601.2c/601.2h, 608.2b). Tell the table it's in the deck.

Not a loop: one token-only doubler (Procession, Parallel Lives, Mondrak, Elspeth) with Phyrexian Altar. That's -1 per iteration.

Any drainer ends it. Slimefoot alone is 1 damage to each opponent per Saproling.

9. Mistakes to avoid

1. **Removing Ghave's last counter** with no sacrifice ready to put one back. He dies as a 0/0.
2. **Spending counters before the doubler lands.** Cast Procession / Parallel Lives / Doubling Season first.
1. **Ordering the counter effects wrong.** Apply Hardened Scales / Kami (+1) **before** Doubling Season (x2). You choose the order (CR 616.1e).

1. **Tapping Saprolings made this turn** for Cryptolith Rite or Brightcap Badger: they're summoning sick. They *can* still be sacrificed.

1. **Clamping a creature with a +1/+1 counter.** It survives. Remove the counter with Ghave first.

2. **Meathook with $X \geq 1$** kills your dorks and 1/1s. Only do it when the deaths are the point.

3. **Mentor of the Meek during an infinite loop:** draw only what you need. Decking yourself is a loss.